

Cary Jones

Senior Python Backend Engineer | Django, AWS & Microservices

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SUMMARY

Senior Python Backend Engineer with 15+ years building enterprise REST APIs, Django applications, and AWS cloud infrastructure. Deep hands-on experience with **Django REST Framework**, containerized microservices on **ECS/Fargate**, PostgreSQL optimization, and production CI/CD pipelines. Proven at enterprise scale — Fidelity (network automation APIs), Disney (\$10M+ daily financial backends), and HIPAA-compliant healthcare platforms — with a track record of reducing latency, improving uptime, and modernizing legacy monoliths into resilient distributed services.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Python & Frameworks: Django, Django REST Framework, FastAPI, Flask, Asyncio, Celery, pytest, SQLAlchemy, Pydantic

AWS & DevOps: ECS, Fargate, Lambda, RDS (PostgreSQL), S3, CloudWatch, Secrets Manager, CodeDeploy, Docker, Kubernetes, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, NGINX

Database & Caching: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, MongoDB, query optimization, indexing, zero-downtime migrations, connection pooling (PgBouncer)

Architecture: Microservices, RESTful API design, event-driven pipelines, OAuth2/JWT auth, legacy-to-microservices modernization, Agile/Scrum

KEY IMPACT

- Built Django REST Framework APIs at Fidelity automating network device provisioning — reduced setup from **4 hours to 10 minutes** and cut manual errors by **95%**.
- Engineered event-driven ETL pipelines on AWS ECS/Fargate handling **2.5M+ daily transactions** at **99.95% accuracy** across PostgreSQL, Redis, and external APIs.
- Architected containerized Python microservices (Django, FastAPI) on AWS, achieving API latency under **120ms** and **+45% throughput** improvement.
- Co-architected Disney financial costing system — cut month-end reconciliation from **8 hours to 45 minutes**; maintained **99.99% uptime** on AWS.
- Expanded automated test coverage from **65% to 92%** using pytest and CI gates, reducing production regression incidents.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Principal Software Engineering Consultant / Technical Lead

Jan 2023 – Present | Los Angeles, CA / Remote

CGJSoftware, Inc.

- Architected and deployed containerized Python microservices (**Django, FastAPI**) on **AWS ECS/Fargate**, reducing API latency to under **120ms** and increasing throughput **45%**.
 - Designed PostgreSQL schemas, optimized ORM queries (`select_related`, `prefetch_related`), and implemented Redis caching for high-read API endpoints.
 - Built CI/CD pipelines (GitHub Actions, Docker) with automated pytest suites, linting, and blue/green ECS deployment configurations.
 - Managed AWS infrastructure: RDS, S3, CloudWatch monitoring, Secrets Manager for credential injection into container tasks.
 - Led legacy backend modernization for enterprise clients — extracting monolith modules into domain-driven microservices with zero-downtime migration patterns.
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Senior Software Engineer

May 2023 – July 2023 | CVS, Inc. (Remote)

- Analyzed and decoupled legacy monolithic Python codebases in preparation for domain-driven microservices architecture.
 - Built containerized domain modules with Docker Compose, improving localized integration testing speed by **50%**.
 - Advised engineering leadership on DDD best practices and inter-service dependency reduction.
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Senior Software Engineer

October 2021 – November 2022 | Disney Corporation, Inc. (Remote)

- Engineered scalable Python backend modules for enterprise financial systems processing **\$10M+ in daily transaction metrics**.
 - Co-architected automated accounting costing system — cut month-end reconciliation from **8 hours to 45 minutes**.
 - Monitored and optimized **AWS** cloud infrastructure, achieving **99.99% uptime** across critical reporting applications.
 - Built high-performance Python database interfaces for **PostgreSQL**, ensuring **100% data integrity** during system migration.
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Python Software Developer and System Architect

July 2019 – October 2021 | CGJSoftware, Inc. (Remote)

- Containerized Python applications with Docker; deployed to GCP and AWS using CI/CD, improving deployment frequency **3x**.
 - Designed event-driven architectures using AWS Pub/Sub and Boto3, ensuring **zero data loss** during peak loads.
 - Optimized complex SQL queries for AWS Redshift, increasing reporting query performance by **38%**.
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API Developer, System Architect, DevOps Engineer, and Scrum Master

January 2018 – July 2019 | Alan Health & Science Corp. (Remote)

- Architected secure Python REST APIs for HIPAA-compliant healthcare platforms serving **500k+ active user profiles**.
 - Configured production Linux environments, SSL/TLS, automated CI/CD pre-deploy scripts, and crontab backups at **99.9% availability**.
 - Managed cross-functional offshore team as Scrum Master; reduced merge conflict incidents by **70%**.
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Python API Developer

August 2013 – April 2014 | Fidelity Investments, Irving, TX

- Built backend API services using **Django REST Framework** for datacenter network device automation — reduced provisioning from **4 hours to 10 minutes** and manual errors by **95%**.
 - Supervised junior developers; mentored on Python best practices, API contract design, and Agile estimation.
 - Architected REST endpoints with custom serializers, permissions, and automated pytest test suites.
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Software Developer in Test

October 2015 – May 2016 | Rackspace, Inc., Austin, TX

- Developed Python REST client executing **1,000+ automated test cases per hour** against core ticketing APIs.
 - Built dynamic test-generator using Python introspection to evaluate API rulesets and uncover edge-case bugs pre-release.
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EDUCATION

Associate of Science, Computer Electronics

2010 – 2013 | ITT Technical Institute, San Diego, CA — GPA 3.67

United States Marine Corps

1995 – 1999 | Field Wireman & Communications Specialist — Honorably Discharged